

Minerals

Over time, the natural processes taking place in underwater rocks produce different minerals, such as salt, magnesium, and titanium. Marine mining is usually done along the coast, to reduce the cost and the damage to the environment.



Seaweed

The largest supplies of seaweed are grown off the coast of Asia—China is the world's leading producer. Seaweed farmers collect this marine plant to sell as food or as an ingredient for medicines.



Fish

Fish can be caught using many different methods. Traditional fishing involves using small boats and nets. Bigger trawlers (fishing boats), however, can drag large nets along the ocean floor to scoop up fish and shellfish in huge amounts.



Fossil fuels

Oil and natural gas are located deep inside layers of rocks under the ocean floor. They can be reached by drilling. The largest offshore oil fields and gas reserves are found in the Persian Gulf, in the Middle East. Fossil fuels are not renewable.

Ocean cargo

Cargo ships can carry more weight than aircraft, while using less fuel. They can transport all kinds of supplies across the oceans in hundreds of box-shaped containers.



Cargo ship packed high with containers